

Title: Back timers and wave management as a weak early game champ

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Silver mundo enjoyer here- I know the basics of wave management and reset timers, aka how to set up a freeze, crash the wave before a back, etc., but when I'm playing a weak early game champ such as Mundo into a Darius, oftentimes I can't find a good time to back because I am always pushed in. The biggest problem I've had is if I manage to set up a freeze to let me farm safely, my opponent just backs and walks back to lane with a gold advantage, which means I cannot contest him if he wants to crash the wave and then freeze it when it pushes away from me. I cannot crash the wave from a freeze with Mundo's early waveclear, I've tried multiple times to do this, but it always ends up slow pushing away from me, making it an even worse time to back. I don't think letting the wave crash into me is the play, as then the wave would bounce, and slow push away from me. To make things worse, sometimes I don't know if my laner is backing or just camping in a bush, so there's a slight delay to whatever choice I make. What is the correct play, and when am I supposed to back in these matchups where I am always pushed in?

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 6]

reality is some situations u have to call ur jg to crash and that just wont happen in low elo

if your opponent bases on a freeze and you know you wont be able to contest him when he gets back to lane then slow push it and crash then you can base

[Comment 2 | Score: 2]

The benefit of Mundo vs Darius is that you're almost always going to have TP advantage because

Darius will take Flash/Ghost. You can take bad trades around the time you have enough gold for a big power spike and then recall/TP to lane to either crash the wave or hold the wave while you're stronger than him.

I'm not an expert on the Mundo vs Darius matchup but it seems to be pretty Mundo favoured or at least a stalemate matchup in my head. Darius can never grab Mundo with E and Mundo can either farm or harass or kite with cleaver (Q). Mundo also wants to build a lot of HP which Darius hates because of his true damage ultimate.

So, you might not be able to prevent the Darius crashing his wave into your tower but you can at least either farm and/or harass initially whilst he does this. Then when the wave is bouncing back to him, take a big trade (but survive) and then recall and TP to your wave. He won't be able to contest and you can then force the crash, recall and let it bounce back. You'll have a big item advantage at this point so you should be able to hold the wave in front of your tower for a freeze. Then once you have 4-5 points in Q and a Giant's Belt (and any other bonus HP you've got by this point) you'll beat Darius in the 1v1.

[Comment 3 | Score: 4]

Hello, fellow Mundo Chad. Some pointers from reading your OP

1. No, you probably aren't going to crash against Darius. You're just not gonna have prio before maybe level 11ish.

2. You're not going to freeze against Darius either, he can Q the wave and it's instantly unfrozen. So between #1 and this, you have to resign that hard control of the wave just isn't in your playbook in laning phase vs a competent Darius.

3. Darius doesn't freeze that well, and Mundo is generally hard or impossible to zone out. Adding the minion changes, you simply shouldn't be frozen on for any length of time. If he is behind the wave, Q farm. If he is in front of the wave, poke him. If it's safe, i.e. enemy jg shows elsewhere, and you have high HP, just walk up and farm, let him hit you, if he Qs in the wave then he breaks his own freeze. This may involve some limit testing to know when he can or can't run you down with ghost. For example, don't let him engage on waves 1-4, you're way too weak at that point. Ideally he burns resources trying to run you down, but you get away still at around half health to get a little extra poke/farm if needed then find a good time to recall and teleport back.

4. You should eventually be winning if top lane is left alone. Be careful about calling for jg help. It's usually not needed, and if your jg happens to get counterganked then you're both getting wiped. If you've tracked their JG and it's safe, go nuts. But JG presence may be more impactful mid or bot.

5. Yes Mundo's early waveclear is considered weak, but ultimately it's tied to how many points you have in E. If you're good enough at farming you can just put in 3 or even just 2 points in Q, then max E. Don't blindly max Q as Mundo. If Darius is blocking your farm too much or trying to zone you out then put an extra point in Q, otherwise E is better so you get more wave control sooner.

6. You can build HS or warmog first, depending on how lane goes, how dangerous enemy ganks/roams are, and personal preference. Consider swifties earlier than normal i.e. after first item. Consider Deadmans third too. I generally like unyielding, but the heal you get from unyielding isn't going to radically change the nature of the Darius matchup, whereas if more slow resist means you don't let Darius heal off Q, that can be huge. Remember, Darius Q heal is based on missing health and enemies hit by outer radius (blade), and as Mundo you notoriously have problems finishing off low health enemies until late game. Don't let him heal.

[Comment 4 | Score: 1]

If you have a freeze and they recall, you can recall too. If it's frozen it will be in the same spot when you get back.

[Comment 5 | Score: -2]

you are letting the enemy dictate the rhythm even though, in theory, you have the control (as per what you said). either you are not doing it properly or you're misplaying anywhere else. darius is not a champion mundo deals with at any point given equal gold, so it's easy to see why it happens, but you should not have trouble early on if you have properly set and manipulated waves in a better way than darius does; his spells will force him to crash and he has to go flash ghost or never get to their targets.

in cases you can't crash, you slowpush from your freeze and force a crash or beg for jg help to crash only, like, having trouble is a given when you pick mundo. darius can clear waves, but can't do so in a meaningful way to deny 2+ waves into hard push so it crashes. you haven't perfected wave manipulation in silver so it's alright, but probably trying to force crashes is your doom. slow pushes and forfeiting golding until your relevance ingame will be better i guess? watch some alois and try understanding what he says and what he does rather than trying to copy. time to focus on micro and understating of trade windows and when you can act into oppressive early champs and proper wave management